

HW 4: Theory

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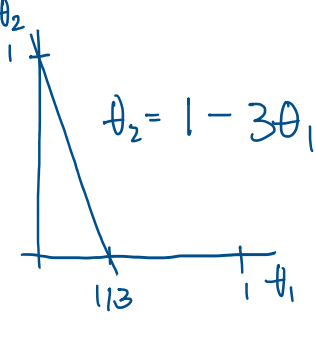
1. Assume X is a discrete random variable that takes values in $\{1, 2, 3\}$, with probability defined by

$$\begin{aligned}\Pr(X=1) &= \theta_1 \\ \Pr(X=2) &= 2\theta_1 \\ \Pr(X=3) &= \theta_2,\end{aligned}$$

where $\theta = [\theta_1, \theta_2]$ is an unknown parameter to be estimated.

Now assume we observe a sequence $D := \{x^{(1)}, x^{(2)}, \dots, x^{(n)}\}$ that is *independent and identically distributed (i.i.d.)* from the distribution. We assume the number of observations of the values: 1, 2, 3 in D are s_1, s_2, s_3 , respectively.

- (a) [5 points] To ensure that $\Pr(X=i)$ is a valid probability mass function, what constraint should we put on $\theta = [\theta_1, \theta_2]$? Write your answers quantitatively as expressions that include θ_1 and θ_2 .

$$\begin{aligned}3\theta_1 + \theta_2 &= 1 \\ 0 &\leq \theta_1 \\ 0 &\leq \theta_2\end{aligned}$$


- (b) [5 points] Write down the joint probability of the data sequence

$$\Pr(D \mid \theta) = \Pr(\{x^{(1)}, \dots, x^{(n)}\} \mid \theta),$$

and the log probability $\log \Pr(D \mid \theta)$.

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(\theta) &= \Pr(\{x^{(1)}, x^{(2)}, \dots, x^{(n)}\} \mid \theta) = \theta_1^{s_1} \cdot (2\theta_1)^{s_2} \cdot \theta_2^{s_3} \\ &= \theta_1^{s_1} \cdot 2^{s_2} \cdot \theta_1^{s_2} \cdot \theta_2^{s_3} \\ &= 2^{s_2} \theta_1^{s_1+s_2} \theta_2^{s_3} \\ &= 2^{s_2} \theta_1^{s_1+s_2} (1-3\theta_1)^{s_3}\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\ell(\theta) &= \ln(2^{s_2} \theta_1^{s_1+s_2} (1-3\theta_1)^{s_3}) \\ &= s_2 \ln(2) + (s_1+s_2) \ln \theta_1 + s_3 \ln(1-3\theta_1)\end{aligned}$$

- (c) [5 points] Calculate the maximum likelihood estimation $\hat{\theta}$ of θ based on the sequence D .

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \theta_1} \ell(\theta) = \cancel{0} + \frac{s_1+s_2}{\theta_1} + \frac{s_3}{1-3\theta_1} (-3)$$

$$0 = (s_1+s_2)(1-3\theta_1) - 3s_3\theta_1$$

$$0 = s_1+s_2 - 3s_1\theta_1 - 3s_2\theta_1 - 3s_3\theta_1$$

$$0 = s_1+s_2 - 3\theta_1(s_1+s_2+s_3)$$

$$0 = \frac{1}{3} \left(\frac{s_1+s_2}{s_1+s_2+s_3} \right) - \theta_1$$

$$\begin{aligned}\nabla'_{\theta_1} \ell(\theta) &= \nabla'_{\theta_1} \left((s_1+s_2)\theta_1^{-1} + s_3(1-3\theta_1)^{-1} \right) \\ &= -\frac{1}{2} (s_1+s_2) \theta_1^{-2} +\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\theta}_1 &= \frac{1}{3} \cdot \frac{s_1+s_2}{s_1+s_2+s_3} \\ \hat{\theta}_2 &= 1 - \frac{s_1+s_2}{s_1+s_2+s_3} = \frac{s_3}{s_1+s_2+s_3}\end{aligned}$$

second derivative test:

$$\frac{\partial^2}{\partial \theta_1^2} \ell(\theta) = -\frac{s_1+s_2}{\theta_1^2} - \frac{s_3}{(1-3\theta_1)^2} (-3) (-3)$$

$$= -\frac{s_1+s_2}{\theta_1^2} - \frac{9s_3}{(1-3\theta_1)^2} < 0$$

$\Rightarrow \mathcal{L}(\theta)$ concave, i.e. we've found a max

2. [10 points] Let $\{x^{(1)}, \dots, x^{(n)}\}$ be an *i.i.d.* sample from an exponential distribution, whose the density function is defined as

$$f(x \mid \beta) = \frac{1}{\beta} \exp\left(-\frac{x}{\beta}\right), \quad \text{for } 0 \leq x < \infty.$$

Please find the maximum likelihood estimator (MLE) of the parameter β . Show your work.

$$f(x \mid \beta) = \frac{1}{\beta} \exp\left(-\frac{x}{\beta}\right), \quad 0 \leq x < \infty$$

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(\beta) &= \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{1}{\beta} \exp\left(-\frac{x_i}{\beta}\right) \\ &= \beta^{-n} \prod_{i=1}^n \exp\left(-\frac{x_i}{\beta}\right) \\ &= \beta^{-n} \exp\left(-\frac{\sum x_i}{\beta}\right)\end{aligned}$$

$$\ell(\beta) = -n \ln(\beta) - \beta^{-1} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \beta} \ell(\beta) = -n\beta^{-1} + \beta^{-2} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i$$

$$0 \stackrel{!}{=} \beta - \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i$$

$$\hat{\beta} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i = \bar{x}$$

$$\frac{\partial^2}{\partial \beta^2} \ell(\beta) = n\beta^{-2} - 2\beta^{-3} \sum x_i$$

$$= n\beta^{-3} (\beta - 2\bar{x})$$

$$< 0 \text{ when } \beta < 2\bar{x}$$

$$\beta = \hat{\beta} = \bar{x} < 2\bar{x} \Rightarrow \hat{\beta} \text{ is a max.}$$

3. (a) [10 points] Assume that you want to investigate the proportion (θ) of defective items manufactured at a production line. You take a random sample of 30 items and found 5 of them were defective. Assume the prior of θ is a uniform distribution on $[0, 1]$. Please compute the posterior of θ . It is sufficient to write down the posterior density function upto a normalization constant that does not depend on θ .

$$\theta \sim \text{uniform}(0, 1), \quad p(\theta) = 1, \quad 0 \leq \theta \leq 1$$

$$y \sim \text{bin}(30, \theta), \quad p(y \mid \theta) = \binom{30}{k} \theta^k (1-\theta)^{30-k}$$

$$p(\theta \mid y=5) \propto p(y=5 \mid \theta) \cdot p(\theta)$$

$$= \binom{30}{5} \theta^5 (1-\theta)^{25} \cdot 1$$

$$\propto \theta^{6-1} (1-\theta)^{26-1} \Rightarrow \theta \sim \text{beta}(6, 26)$$

- (b) [10 points] Assume an observation $D := \{x^{(1)}, \dots, x^{(n)}\}$ is *i.i.d.* drawn from a Gaussian distribution $\mathcal{N}(\mu, 1)$, with an unknown mean μ and a variance of 1. Assume the prior distribution of μ is $\mathcal{N}(0, 1)$. Please derive the posterior distribution $p(\mu \mid D)$ of μ given data D .

$$\mu \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1), \quad p(\mu) \propto \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}\mu^2\right)$$

$$x \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, 1), \quad p(x \mid \mu) \propto \exp\left(-\frac{(x-\mu)^2}{2}\right)$$

$$p(D \mid \mu) \propto \prod_{i=1}^n \exp\left(-\frac{(x_i-\mu)^2}{2}\right)$$

$$= \exp\left(-\frac{\sum (x_i-\mu)^2}{2}\right)$$

$$x \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$$

$$f(x) = (2\pi\sigma^2)^{-1/2} \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}(x-\mu)^2\right)$$

$$p(\mu \mid D) \propto p(D \mid \mu) \cdot p(\mu)$$

$$\propto \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \sum (x_i-\mu)^2\right) \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}\mu^2\right)$$

$$= \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\sum (x_i-\mu)^2 + \mu^2 \right)\right)$$

$$= \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\sum x_i^2 - 2\mu \sum x_i + \mu^2 \right) + \mu^2\right)$$

$$= \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\sum x_i^2 - 2\mu \sum x_i + (n+1)\mu^2 \right)\right)$$

$$\propto \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left((n+1)\mu^2 - 2\mu \sum x_i \right)\right)$$

$$\propto \exp\left(-\frac{n+1}{2} \left(\mu^2 - 2\mu \frac{\sum x_i}{n+1} \right)\right)$$

$$\propto \exp\left(\frac{1}{2(n+1)} \left(\mu - \frac{\sum x_i}{n+1} \right)^2\right)$$

$$\begin{aligned}\Rightarrow \mu \mid D &\sim \mathcal{N}\left(\mu = \frac{\sum x_i}{n+1}, \sigma^2 = \frac{1}{n+1}\right) \\ p(\mu \mid D) &= (2\pi \frac{1}{n+1})^{-1/2} \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{n+1}\right)^{-1} \left(\mu - \frac{\sum x_i}{n+1}\right)^2\right) \\ &= (2\pi)^{-1/2} (n+1)^{1/2} \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} (n+1) \left(\mu - \frac{\sum x_i}{n+1}\right)^2\right)\end{aligned}$$

By Bayes's rule we can simply identify the kernel of a prob. distribution and assume the normalizing constants will work themselves out, i.e. the pdf will integrate to 1. This is how I am able to add and remove constant factors while doing algebra above.